

अयमात्मा ब्रह्म

Ayam Ātmā Brahma

"This Self is Brahman"

(One of the Four Great Mahāvākyas of the Upaniṣads)

संस्कृत

अयमात्मा ब्रह्म ।

— माण्डूक्य उपनिषद् (२)

हिन्दी चिन्तन

चार महावाक्यों में यह सबसे अधिक अन्तर्मुखी है ।

यह नहीं कहता—

"वह ब्रह्म है ।"

यह नहीं कहता—

"कहीं दूर परमात्मा है ।"

यह कहता है—

"यह आत्मा ही ब्रह्म है ।"

"अयम्"—अर्थात् जो अभी, यहीं, प्रत्यक्ष है ।

जो सबसे निकट है ।

जिसे पाने के लिए कहीं जाना नहीं पड़ता ।

जिसके लिए समय की प्रतीक्षा नहीं करनी पड़ती ।

जिसे किसी प्रमाण से सिद्ध नहीं करना पड़ता ।

वह कौन है?

वह शरीर नहीं ।

वह मन नहीं ।

वह बुद्धि नहीं ।

वह अहंकार भी नहीं ।

इन सबको जानने वाला,

इन सबका साक्षी,

जो जाग्रत में भी है,

स्वप्न में भी है,

सुषुप्ति में भी है,

और तीनों अवस्थाओं के परिवर्तन का भी साक्षी है—

वही आत्मा है ।

और उपनिषद् कहता है—

वही ब्रह्म है ।

इससे निकट कोई सत्य नहीं ।

इससे बड़ा कोई रहस्य नहीं ।

English Reflection

Among the four Mahāvākyas, this one turns our attention most directly inward.

It does not point toward a distant God.

It does not ask us to search in another world.

It simply declares:

"This very Self is Brahman."

Notice the word "**This.**"

Not tomorrow.

Not after death.

Not elsewhere.

Not someone else's Self.

This Self.

The Awareness that is reading these words.

The silent Presence before every thought.

The Witness of childhood,

youth,

old age,

waking,

dream,

and deep sleep.

That Presence has never aged.

Never diminished.

Never become divided.

The Upaniṣad boldly declares:

That is Brahman.

Nothing more needs to be added.

Nothing can be taken away.

The Four Mahāvākyas

Each Mahāvākya illumines the same Truth from a unique standpoint.

प्रज्ञानं ब्रह्म

Prajñānam Brahma

Pure Consciousness is Brahman.

It reveals **the nature of Brahman**.

अहं ब्रह्मास्मि

Aham Brahmāsmi

I am Brahman.

It reveals **the identity of the seeker**.

तत्त्वमसि

Tat Tvam Asi

Thou art That.

It is the **Guru's instruction** to the disciple.

अयमात्मा ब्रह्म

Ayam Ātmā Brahma

This Self is Brahman.

It is the **direct recognition** that the ever-present Self is none other than the Infinite.

Thus, the four Mahāvākyas are not four different doctrines.

They are four windows opening toward the same limitless sky.

Living Vedanta Reflection

We often ask,

"Where is God?"

The Mahāvākya gently asks us a different question:

"Who is asking?"

Before the mind searches,

before the intellect concludes,

before words arise,

there is simple Awareness.

That Awareness is never absent.

It is not an object to be found.

It is the Light by which all objects are known.

To discover That is not to become something new.

It is to awaken to what has always been.

Living Vedanta Library Takeaway

The journey of Vedānta is not from earth to heaven.

It is not from the individual to another Reality.

It is from mistaken identity

to true identity.

When the Upaniṣad says—

"अयमात्मा ब्रह्म"

it removes the final distance between the seeker and the Sought.

Nothing remains to be reached.

Nothing remains to be acquired.

The seeker discovers that the One he has been searching for
has always been the very Self.

अयमात्मा ब्रह्म ।

This Self is Brahman.



— Living Vedanta Library